g. What does the phrase 'full galloping' suggest?
h. Why was the rider in a hurry?
i. What did the rider do when he reached Napoleon?
j. Why did the rider keep his lips compressed ?
k. Where did the rider plant the French flag after Ratisbon was captured?
l. What was Napoleon's reaction on hearing the news of victory?
m. When did the narrator find that the boy was badly wounded?
n. Why did Napoleon's eyes become soft as a mother eagle's eyes?
o. How did the young soldier face his end?

3.Literary Devices

Mark the rhyme scheme of the poem. The rhyme scheme for the first stanza is as follows.

With neck out-thrust, you fancy how, a
Legs wide, arms locked behind, b
As if to balance the prone brow a
Oppressive with its mind. b

i) **Alliteration**: "Alliteration is the repetition of the same consonant sound in successive or nearby words." Note that in alliteration the sound and sense go together. For example,

Let once my army-leader Lannes
Waver at yonder wall',

In the first line, /l/ is repeated (Let- leader- Lannes), and in the second line /w/ is repeated (waver- wall). Find out two more instances of alliteration.

ii) **Synecdoche**: "A figure of speech in which a part is made to represent the whole or vice-versa". For example,

You know, we French stormed Ratisbon.

Here, the word 'French' refers to the country and not the army.

4. Read the lines given below and answer the questions that follow.

a) Legs wide, arms locked behind,
As if to balance the prone brow
Oppressive with its mind.

i. Whose action is described here?
ii. What is meant by prone brow?
iii. What is his state of mind?

b) 'You're wounded!' 'Nay', his soldier's pride
Touched to the quick, he said:

i. Why did the boy contradict Napoleon's words?
ii. Why was his pride touched?

c) A film the mother-eagle's eye
When her bruised eaglet breathes

i. Who is compared to the mother eagle in the above lines?
ii. Explain the comparison.

5) Explain the following lines with reference to the context.

i. Then off there flung in smiling joy,
And held himself erect

ii. 'I'm killed, Sire!' And, his Chief beside,
Smiling, the boy fell dead.

iii. To see your flag-bird flap his vans
Where I, to heart's desire,
Perched him!'

6. Answer the following questions in about 100–150 words each.

a. The young soldier matched his emperor in courage and patriotism. Elucidate your answer.

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